

High and low

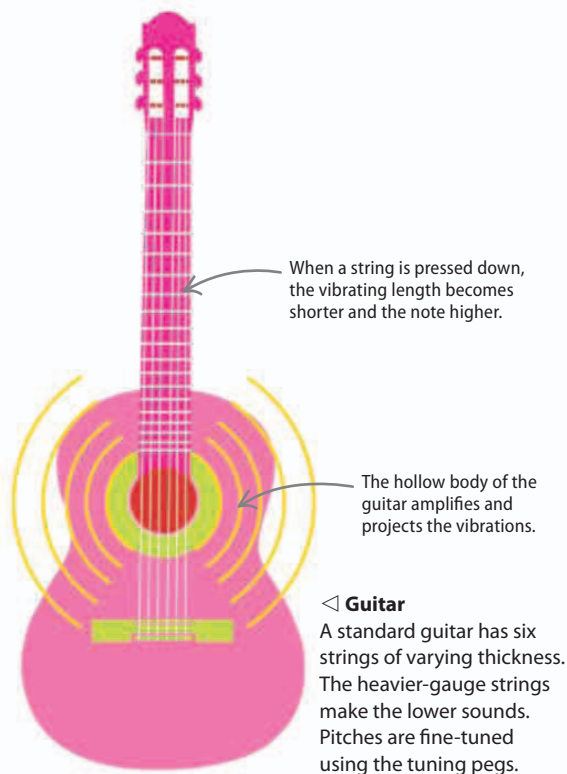
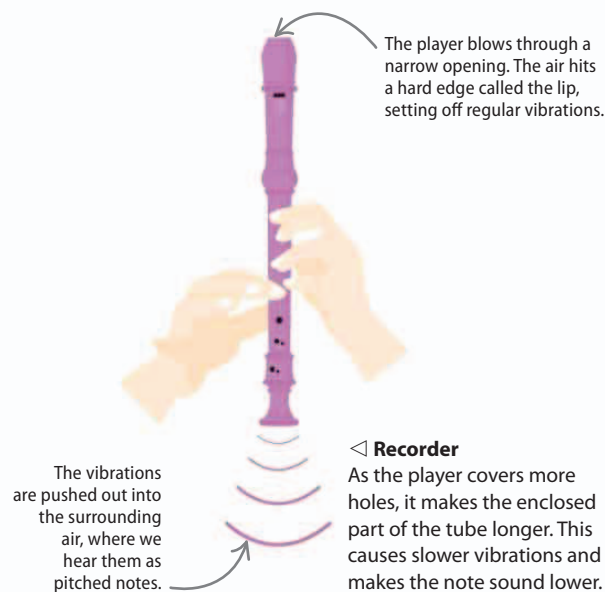
When we play notes on an instrument, one at a time, or sing a few notes, we can distinguish one note from another by their pitch—some notes are higher, and some are lower.

SEE ALSO

The piano keyboard	16–17 >
Major scales	60–61 >
Strings	174–175 >
Brass	178–179 >

How music sounds are made

Musical sounds are vibrations in the air. When the vibrations are regular, we can hear exact pitches. We hear high notes when the vibrations are fast, and lower notes when the vibrations are slower.



High and low sounds

Smaller objects generally vibrate faster and make higher sounds. On a piano or harp, the shorter strings make the high notes. In families of instruments, such as saxophones or the violin family, the smaller instruments play the higher notes. Tuned percussion instruments, such as the xylophone, have a set of bars graded from large (low notes) to small (high notes).

